

So I'm working in my aetherium codex setting and I need to codify conditions like blind or bleeding. Can you give me a summary list of all the ones called out in the sources?

Based on the AE Alpha combined v4.md and Complete Talent System Reference.md files, the Aetherium Codex splits status effects into two distinct categories: Condition Tracks (progressive degradation based on the Four Pillars) and Discrete Conditions (specific binary effects like Blind or Stunned).

Here is the codified summary list of all conditions called out in your source text.

1. The Four Condition Tracks

These are progressive states. A character moves down a track when they take damage exceeding their Damage Threshold or via specific abilities.

Physical Track (Vitality)

- * Step 1: Winded: -1 penalty on physical checks.
- * Step 2: Reeling: -2 penalty on physical checks; Speed -10 ft.
- * Step 3: Wounded: -5 penalty on physical checks; Speed -20 ft; Strength actions require Vigor check.
- * Step 4: Crippled: -10 penalty on physical checks; Speed halved; cannot run.
- * Step 5: Incapacitated: Unconscious/Dying.

Mental Track (Clarity)

- * Step 1: Distracted: -1 penalty on mental checks.
- * Step 2: Shaken: -2 penalty on mental checks; Disadvantage on Initiative.
- * Step 3: Frightened: -5 penalty on mental checks; aggressive actions require Wits check (TN 15).
- * Step 4: Befuddled: -10 penalty on mental checks; Gain Confused condition.
- * Step 5: Incapacitated: Catatonic/Unresponsive.

Social Track (Poise)

- * Step 1: Flustered: -1 penalty on social checks.
- * Step 2: Humbled: -2 penalty on social checks; Disadvantage on Presence checks.
- * Step 3: Disgraced: -5 penalty on social checks; lose status benefits.
- * Step 4: Rapt: -10 penalty on ALL checks; Gain Flat-Footed condition.
- * Step 5: Incapacitated: Broken (flee, surrender, or compliant).

Metaphysical Track (Pattern Integrity)

- * Step 1: Frayed: -1 penalty on metaphysical checks; sensory distortion.
- * Step 2: Strained: -2 penalty on metaphysical checks; minor uncontrolled phenomena.
- * Step 3: Corrupted: -5 penalty on metaphysical checks; temporary cosmetic mutation.
- * Step 4: Unraveling: -10 penalty on ALL checks; Gain Staggered condition.
- * Step 5: Incapacitated: Dissolving (ejected from plane or comatose).

2. Discrete Status Conditions

These are binary effects applied by talents, spells, or specific track steps.

Action & Combat Modifiers

- * Flat-Footed: Enemies gain Advantage on attacks against you. You cannot take Reactions (no Shield Block, parry, etc.).
- * Stunned: You cannot take any actions (Standard, Move, Swift, or Reaction). You lose Dodge Defense (effectively Flat-Footed). Duration is typically 1 round.

* Staggered: You may take either a Standard Action or a Move Action, but not both. You cannot take Reactions or Swift Actions.

* Dazed: Functionally identical to Staggered in your current text ("can take only a Standard Action or Move action, not both"). Used in Intimidation talents like Concussive Flourish.

* Confused: You cannot distinguish friend from foe. Roll d4 at start of turn: (1) Attack nearest creature, (2) Do Nothing, (3) Move randomly, (4) Attack self.

* Restrained: Implies immobilization (referenced in Spiked Ceiling trap description).

Physical Afflictions

* Bleeding: You take ongoing damage per turn (e.g., 1 damage per 2 precision dice) until healed. Referenced in Arterial Strike and Bleeding Critical.

* Blinded: Unable to see. Suffer -2 to all perception-based checks. Referenced in Blinding Critical.

* Hampered: Movement speed reduced by -2 (or 10 ft). Referenced in Rogue talent Debilitating Strike.

* Off-Balance: -2 to Dodge Defense. Referenced in Rogue talent Debilitating Strike.

* Fatigued: -1 to all actions. Caused by reaching 0 Stamina via Sapping Strike.

Long-Term Afflictions

* Cursed: Independent of tracks. May cause ongoing Metaphysical track movement or specific penalties. Requires ritual removal.

* Poisoned / Diseased: Independent of tracks. May cause ongoing Physical track movement. Requires antidote/medicine.

* Planar Strain: Accumulates at 1 point per hour in bleed zones. If Strain > Integrity, risk acquiring a Mutation.

<https://www.d20pfsrd.com/gamemastering/conditions/> compare against the pf1e conditions to identify ones that I'm missing.

Based on a cross-reference between your Aetherium Codex (AE) sources and the standard Pathfinder 1e (PF1e) condition list, here is the breakdown.

1. Critical Missing Conditions

These are standard conditions in PF1e that do not appear in your summary lists and do not have a clear "rename" in your system.

* Deafened: You have Blinded, but no corresponding condition for hearing loss (which usually imposes Initiative penalties and Spell Failure chance for verbal components).

* Petrified: You have Paralyzed (via Stunned/Incapacitated), but no specific condition for being turned to stone (which usually grants hardness/damage immunity).

* Prone: This is likely treated as a tactical posture in your combat chapter, but it is technically a "condition" in PF1e. It is not called out in your discrete condition list.

* Invisible: Like Prone, this is often a spell effect, but functions as a condition in PF1e.

* Dazzled: You have Blinded, but no "minor" vision impairment condition (PF1e Dazzled is just -1 to Perception/Attacks).

* Note: Your Frayed (Metaphysical Step 1) mentions "sensory distortion," which could act as a Dazzled equivalent if applied physically.

2. Conditions Subsumed by Your "Four Tracks"

Your Track system effectively replaces these PF1e conditions. You likely don't need to add them, but you should know they are "covered."

| PF1e Condition | Aetherium Codex Equivalent | Notes |

|---|---|---|

| Sickened | Reeling (Physical Step 2) | Sickened is -2 to all checks; Reeling is -2 to physical checks + speed loss. |

| Nauseated | Staggered | Nauseated restricts you to move actions only. Your Staggered allows Standard OR Move, effectively covering this mechanical niche. |

| Exhausted | Crippled (Physical Step 4) | Exhausted is half speed + stat penalties. Crippled is half speed + -10 penalty. |

| Cowering | Frightened (Mental Step 3) | Your Frightened forces a check to act aggressively; combined with Stunned, this covers Cowering. |

| Panicked | Befuddled (Mental Step 4) | Your Befuddled applies -10 Mental and leads to Confused. |

| Fascinated | Rapt (Social Step 4) | Your Rapt makes the target Flat-Footed and imposes -10 to checks. |

| Energy Drained | Metaphysical Track | PF1e Negative Levels are best represented by damage to your Metaphysical (Integrity) track. |

3. Renamed or Adjusted Conditions

These PF1e conditions exist in your system but use different terminology or mechanics.

- * Entangled: Your system splits this into Restrained (immobilized) and Hampered (speed reduced).

- * Gap Check: PF1e Entangled also applies -2 Attack / -4 Dex. Your Hampered only reduces speed. You might consider adding a "Snared" condition that bridges the gap (Speed penalty + Attack penalty) without full restraint.

- * Grappled / Pinned: Your Restrained condition likely covers both, depending on severity.

- * Helpless: You use Incapacitated (Step 5 of any track) or Stunned.

- * Disabled: Covered by Staggered or the specific mechanics of being at 0 HP.

4. Item Conditions

- * Broken: In PF1e, this applies to weapons/armor/tools. Your Social Track has a "Broken" state for people (Step 5 Incapacitated), but your source text does not explicitly define a Broken condition for equipment. You may need to codify this if you have rules for Sunder or item degradation.

Summary of Recommended Additions

To fully round out your list, I recommend codifying these three:

- * Deafened: (e.g., -4 Initiative, Disadvantage on Perception).

- * Prone: (e.g., Disadvantage on melee attacks, Advantage on Ranged Defense, Move Action to stand).

- * Petrified: (e.g., Weight x10, Hardness 8, Incapacitated).

Let's get a reorganized list that lists out all my listed status conditions, missing status conditions, and the "subsumed" status conditions separated from the condition tracks. Let's include your snared, helpless, and disabled suggestions.

I need the status conditions inflicted by condition tracks separated out to be able to apply them as external effects like being afflicted artificially from spells.

Here is the reorganized master list of status conditions for the Aetherium Codex.

I have separated the Track Conditions so they can be applied as independent spell effects (e.g., "Target suffers the Wounded condition"), added the Missing/New conditions, and created a reference table for the Subsumed conditions.

1. Tactical & Action Conditions

These conditions primarily dictate what actions a creature can or cannot take.

- * Confused: Creature cannot distinguish friend from foe. Rolls d4 at start of turn: (1) Attack nearest, (2) Do Nothing, (3) Move randomly, (4) Attack self.

- * Dazed: Creature can take either a Standard Action or a Move Action, but not both. No Reactions. (Mental/Pain based).

- * Disabled (New): Creature is at the brink of consciousness (typically 0 HP). Can take only a single Move or Standard action. Taking a Standard action causes 1 damage.

- * Flat-Footed: Creature cannot react to threats. Enemies gain Advantage on attacks against you. You cannot take Reactions (no Block, Parry, etc.).

- * Helpless (New): Creature is bound, sleeping, or unconscious. Dexterity counts as 0 (-5). Melee attacks against the target automatically hit (or have massive Advantage) and may crit automatically.

- * Prone (New): Creature is lying on the ground. Movement to stand up costs an Action (or half movement). Disadvantage on Melee Attacks made by the creature. Attackers have Advantage on Melee attacks against the creature, but Disadvantage on Ranged attacks against it.

- * Staggered: Creature can take either a Standard Action or a Move Action, but not both. No Reactions. (Physical/Nausea based).

- * Stunned: Creature drops everything held, cannot take actions, takes a -2 penalty to AC, and loses its Dexterity bonus to AC (if any).

2. Mobility & Restriction Conditions

These conditions primarily affect movement and positioning.

- * Hampered: Movement speed is reduced by -2 squares (10 ft). Cannot take the Run or Charge actions.

- * Off-Balance: Creature suffers -2 to Dodge Defense and Reflex saves.

- * Restrained: Creature is immobilized (Speed 0). Disadvantage on Attack rolls and Dexterity checks. Attackers have Advantage against the creature.

- * Snared (New): Bridge between Hampered and Restrained. Creature is anchored to a spot but can still fight. Speed is 0, but the creature is not "Bound." Suffer -2 on Attack rolls and AC.

3. Sensory Conditions

These conditions affect perception and accuracy.

- * Blinded: Creature cannot see. Suffer -2 (or Disadvantage) to all perception-based checks and Armor Class. All opponents have Total Concealment (50% miss chance).

- * Deafened (New): Creature cannot hear. Suffer -4 to Initiative. Automatically fail listening-based Perception checks. 20% Spell Failure chance for spells with Verbal components.

4. Physical Trauma Conditions

These conditions represent ongoing physical degradation.

- * Bleeding: Creature takes ongoing damage per turn (Fixed amount or based on dice) until treated with Medicine or Healing magic.
- * Fatigued: Creature is exhausted. -1 penalty to all Checks and Attacks. Cannot Run or Charge.
- * Petrified (New): Creature is turned to solid stone. Target is considered Unconscious, gains Hardness 8, and weight increases by x10.
- * Poisoned / Diseased: Specific effects based on the toxin/pathogen, typically inflicting Track Damage over time.

5. Track-Derived Conditions (Externalized)

These are the specific steps of your Four Pillars. You can now assign these as specific magical effects (e.g., a "Ray of Enfeeblement" causing the Wounded condition without dealing HP damage).

Physical Conditions (Vitality)

- * Winded: -1 penalty on physical checks.
- * Reeling: -2 penalty on physical checks; Speed -10 ft.
- * Wounded: -5 penalty on physical checks; Speed -20 ft; Strength actions require Vigor check.
- * Crippled: -10 penalty on physical checks; Speed halved; cannot run.

Mental Conditions (Clarity)

- * Distracted: -1 penalty on mental checks.
- * Shaken: -2 penalty on mental checks; Disadvantage on Initiative.
- * Frightened: -5 penalty on mental checks; aggressive actions require Wits check (TN 15).
- * Befuddled: -10 penalty on mental checks; Gain Confused behavior.

Social Conditions (Poise)

- * Flustered: -1 penalty on social checks.
- * Humbled: -2 penalty on social checks; Disadvantage on Presence checks.
- * Disgraced: -5 penalty on social checks; lose all status/reputation benefits.
- * Rapt: -10 penalty on ALL checks; Gain Flat-Footed condition (Target is mesmerized).

Metaphysical Conditions (Integrity)

- * Frayed: -1 penalty on metaphysical checks; sensory distortion.
- * Strained: -2 penalty on metaphysical checks; minor uncontrolled magical phenomena.
- * Corrupted: -5 penalty on metaphysical checks; temporary cosmetic mutation.
- * Unraveling: -10 penalty on ALL checks; Gain Staggered condition (Reality is rejecting the target).

6. Subsumed Condition Reference Table

Use this when converting PF1e modules or mechanics to the Aetherium Codex.

| Pathfinder 1e Condition | Aetherium Codex Equivalent |

|---|---|

| Sickened | Reeling (Physical Track) or Distracted (Mental Track) |

| Nauseated | Staggered (Standard Condition) |

| Exhausted | Crippled (Physical Track) or Fatigued (if Stamina based) |

| Cowering | Frightened (Mental Track) or Stunned |

| Panicked | Befuddled (Mental Track) or Confused |

| Fascinated | Rapt (Social Track) |

| Energy Drained | Damage to Metaphysical Track (Integrity) |

| Dazzled | Frayed (Metaphysical Track) or Distracted |

| Entangled | Snared (If anchored) or Hampered (If slowed) |
| Pinned | Restrained |

Alright let's look at the skills. There are 12 skills broken into three petals. Let's examine the skills against pf1e, 3.5, oWoD, and aberrant skills to determine if I'm missing any major categories.

I'm specially looking to fill 4 more slots so I can have 4 skills in the physical abilities tree, 4 skills in mental, 4 skills in social, and 4 skills in metaphysical sections.

Based on a cross-reference of your current 12 skills against Pathfinder 1e, D&D 3.5, Old World of Darkness (oWoD), and Aberrant, here is the analysis of the missing categories and a recommendation to fill your 4x4 grid.

The Gap Analysis

Comparing your list to standard systems reveals four major "missing" competencies:

- * The "Sherlock" Gap (Mental): You have Lore (knowing facts) and Insight (reading people), but no skill for active deduction, forensics, or finding physical clues. In PF1e, this is Perception (Search) and Appraise; in oWoD, this is Investigation.

- * The "Mount/Vehicle" Gap (Physical): You have Athletics (your body) and Operate (magical machines), but no skill for handling animals, riding mounts, or piloting non-magical vehicles. In PF1e, this is Ride, Fly, and Handle Animal; in Aberrant, it's Drive and Pilot.

- * The "Focus" Gap (Metaphysical): You have Integrity (passive save) and Metaphysics (passive perception), but no skill for active mental resistance, meditation, or maintaining spells under duress. In PF1e/3.5, this is Concentration; in oWoD, Meditation. This is critical for your "Condition Track" system to resist Strain.

- * The "Ritual" Gap (Metaphysical): You have Operate (devices) and Metaphysics (theory), but no skill for the slow, ceremonial application of magic (binding entities, drawing circles, forging pacts). In PF1e, this is usually rolled into Spellcraft, but in a setting with "Pacts" and "Vestiges," a dedicated binding skill is distinct from "combat magic."

Recommended 16-Skill Grid

Here is your new list, reorganized into 4 distinct trees with the 4 New Skills added in bold.

1. Physical Tree (The Body & Motion)

Primary Attributes: Might, Finesse, Vigor

- * Athletics: Climbing, swimming, jumping, and raw physical feats.

- * Skulduggery: Stealth, lockpicking, sleight of hand, and infiltration. (Moved here as it is primarily Finesse-based).

- * Survival: Navigation, tracking, enduring the elements, and foraging.

- * Handling (NEW): Riding mounts, driving vehicles, animal taming, and piloting. Covers the interaction with physical entities that aren't you.

2. Mental Tree (Logic & Analysis)

Primary Attributes: Intellect, Wits

- * Lore: Academic knowledge, history, languages, and theory.

- * Medicine: Anatomy, healing, surgery, and treating disease.

- * Artifice: Crafting, engineering, repair, and disable device (sabotage).

* Investigation (NEW): Forensics, searching a room, deduction, research, and puzzle-solving. The art of finding what is hidden.

3. Social Tree (Interaction & Persona)

Primary Attributes: Presence, Guile, Composure

* Influence: Persuasion, leadership, command, and intimidation.

* Streetwise: Urban survival, contacts, gathering rumors, and criminal politics.

* Performance: Oratory, acting, music, and emotional manipulation.

* Insight: Reading motives, detecting lies, empathy, and sensing emotional states. (Moved here from "Perception" as it is the core Social Defense skill).

4. Metaphysical Tree (The Soul & Magic)

Primary Attributes: Acuity, Dominion, Anima

* Metaphysics: Magical theory, identifying spells, and perceiving auras/spirits.

* Operate: Using magical devices, tuning golems, and hacking magical constructs.

* Discipline (NEW): Meditation, concentration, resisting mental/magical strain, and suppressing mutations. The "Constitution" of the mind.

* Ritual (NEW): Forging pacts, binding vestiges, ceremonial magic, and creating warding circles. The engineering of the soul.

Why These Additions?

* Handling: Without this, a character has no way to be a "Pilot" or "Cavalier," which are classic archetypes (e.g., Command/Knight).

* Investigation: Essential for Investigator and Spymaster archetypes. It separates "I know this fact" (Lore) from "I found this bloodstain" (Investigation).

* Discipline: Your game features Condition Tracks and Strain. You need a skill that represents a character's trained ability to say "No" to corruption and hold onto their sanity/spells.

* Ritual: This supports your Summoner and Pact systems. It differentiates the "Wizard" (Lore/Metaphysics) from the "Cultist/Binder" (Ritual).

I agree with the Sherlock gap but I don't want it to be perception or investigate as both have wildly different connotations and I think perception is over used.

Operate is for operations on any device, not just magical, separate from crafting it. I agree with the mount/vehicle gap but I'm looking for something that can be applied in a multipurpose role or be broken down, like lore, into smaller roles/specialties under the same skill umbrella.

If I need a check to maintain concentration it shouldn't be a "skill". Also, metaphysics acts as my setting's spellcraft covering the magical knowledge and understanding.

With these corrections can you give me about 4 more options each

This is a great pivot. You want skills that act as umbrellas (like Lore) to allow for specialization, while avoiding the "Perception" trap and ensuring "Concentration" remains a Save/Check rather than a skill.

Here are 4 distinct options for each of your empty slots, designed to fit the Aetherium Codex tone.

1. Physical: The "Motion & Control" Gap

Constraint Checklist: Needs to cover mounts AND vehicles, act as an umbrella for specialties, and fit a magi-tech world.

* Option A: Conveyance

* The Vibe: Academic, formal, and all-encompassing. It implies the mastery of getting from point A to B.

* Why it works: It cleanly breaks down into specialties like Conveyance (Beast), Conveyance (Void-Skiff), Conveyance (Naval), or Conveyance (Steam-Walker). It covers the handling, the piloting, and the basic maintenance of the ride.

* Option B: Navigation

* The Vibe: Exploration and travel-focused.

* Why it works: It shifts the focus from "steering the wheel" to "mastering the environment." A roll for Navigation covers piloting through a storm, finding a path through the Borderlands, or guiding a mount through a swamp. Specialties would be terrain-based (Sky, Sea, Void).

* Option C: Maneuver

* The Vibe: Tactical and action-oriented.

* Why it works: This sounds like a skill used in the heat of the moment. It covers stunt driving, combat riding, and evasive flying. It leaves the boring "travel" stuff to Survival and focuses on control under pressure.

* Option D: Sortie

* The Vibe: Military and mission-focused.

* Why it works: Fits the Academy/Militant themes of Stormpeak and Deepguard. It implies a skill used for deploying vehicles or mounts for specific operations.

2. Mental: The "Sherlock" Gap

Constraint Checklist: Needs to be active deduction/finding, must NOT be "Perception" or "Investigation."

* Option A: Scrutiny

* The Vibe: Intense, deliberate, and detailed.

* Why it works: "Perception" is passive; "Scrutiny" is active. You don't "passive Scrutiny" a room. You roll Scrutiny when you are tossing the apartment, examining the corpse for needle marks, or checking a contract for invisible ink. It is the skill of finding the flaw.

* Option B: Inquiry

* The Vibe: Curative, persistent, and interrogative.

* Why it works: This covers both searching a physical space and "searching" a person through questioning. It is the skill of asking the right questions—whether you are asking a library database, a witness, or a crime scene.

* Option C: Analysis

* The Vibe: Cold, logical, and scientific.

* Why it works: If "Lore" is knowing facts, "Analysis" is processing them. It covers forensics, breaking down a cipher, or figuring out the trajectory of a spell. It turns the environment into data.

* Option D: Awareness

* The Vibe: Instinctual and sensory.

* Why it works: If you want to stay closer to the traditional mechanic but change the flavor, Awareness implies a "sixth sense" or a heightened state of being, rather than just "eyesight."

3. Social: The "Subtlety & Systems" Gap

Constraint Checklist: You have Influence (Force), Streetwise (Grit), and Performance (Art). You are missing the "Liar" or the "Bureaucrat."

* Option A: Protocol

* The Vibe: Structured, rigid, and elite.

* Why it works: In a world of massive Academies and Divine Courts, knowing the rules is a weapon. Protocol covers etiquette, navigating bureaucracy, legal proceedings (Lex/Themis), and knowing who to bow to. It is the "Streetwise" of the upper crust.

* Option B: Subterfuge

* The Vibe: Deceptive, shadowy, and manipulative.

* Why it works: "Skullduggery" is usually physical (locks/pickpocketing). Subterfuge is the Social counterpart. It covers lying, disguises, forgery, and passing secret codes. It fills the "Spy" niche perfectly.

* Option C: Guile

* The Vibe: Clever, slippery, and charming.

* Why it works: If Influence is a hammer, Guile is a scalpel. It covers fast-talking, seduction (if not Performance), trickery, and feinting in social scenarios.

* Option D: Mediation

* The Vibe: Peaceful, constructive, and empathetic.

* Why it works: You have no skill for making peace. Influence forces compliance; Mediation builds consensus. Essential for the "Good Cop" or the Diplomat archetype.

4. Metaphysical: The "Application" Gap

Constraint Checklist: No Concentration, no Spellcraft. Needs to cover the use or interaction with magic beyond just pushing the "on" button (Operate).

* Option A: Ritual

* The Vibe: Ceremonial, slow, and powerful.

* Why it works: Casting a spell is a combat action; performing a Ritual is a skill. This covers binding entities (Summoning), creating warding circles, purifying a cursed object, or stabilizing a Planar Bleed. It is the "Engineering" of the soul.

* Option B: Resonance

* The Vibe: Sensory and reactive.

* Why it works: This is the "Perception" of magic. It covers reading auras, sensing magical traps, tracking a teleportation signature, or identifying a spell being cast by the vibrations in the air.

* Option C: Invocation

* The Vibe: Relational and pact-based.

* Why it works: Distinct from "Religion" (Lore). This is the practical skill of bargaining with extra-planar entities, spirits, or vestiges. It fits your Summoner/Pact themes perfectly.

* Option D: Attunement

* The Vibe: Connection and harmony.

* Why it works: Represents the character's ability to sync their Pattern Integrity with external items or places. Could be used to safely handle volatile artifacts, interface with sentient dungeons (The Palimpsest), or resist ambient corruption.

My Recommendation for a Balanced "Aetherium" Grid:

- * Conveyance: (Fits the magi-tech/void-skiff aesthetic; allows specialization).
- * Scrutiny: (Distinguishes "active search" from passive sight; fits the Noir/Investigator vibe).
- * Protocol: (Essential for a setting dominated by Colleges and Gods of Law; distinct from Streetwise).
- * Ritual: (Crucial for a setting with Planar Bleed, Vestiges, and Summoning as major pillars).

I like conveyance. The Sherlock gap needs to cover *both* passive and active searching and fit that feeling. Influence is the same as protocol but should cover a wider area as part of having influence is knowing protocol involved in social combat and is needed for influence to work but it's just one piece of the puzzle. I'm leaning toward subterfuge instead of guile as it's an ability. Influence also covers making peace and negotiating a diplomatic solution in an otherwise hostile environment. However as a part of influence it's the social subterfuge, like lying, as well meaning that we don't need subterfuge as it's covered by influence - subterfuge is still causing influences just from a negative connotation.

None of options in option 3 struck a chord. Go back to board opening up the other concepts I'm missing and try again as influence and option 3 weren't necessary. You also need to come up with a different name for option 2 for the "Sherlock" gap.

Here is the revised breakdown. We are locking in Conveyance for the Physical tree.

For the remaining gaps, we need to respect that Influence is your "Super-Skill" for social output (Command, Deceit, Negotiation, Protocol). This means the missing Social skill shouldn't be about doing social things, but about managing or reading them.

Here are the new recommendations for the Mental, Social, and Metaphysical slots.

1. The Mental Tree: The "Sherlock" Gap

The Need: A skill that covers Active Searching (tossing a room, forensics) and Passive Noticing (spotting a tail, hearing a snap), without being called "Perception" or "Investigation."

* Option A: Discernment

* The Vibe: Sharp, piercing, and judgmental. It implies distinguishing the true from the false.

* Why it works: It works passively ("You discern a faint scratching sound") and actively ("I discern the hidden catch on the bookshelf"). It fits a noir/mystery tone perfectly.

* Option B: Vigilance

* The Vibe: Watchful, protective, and constant.

* Why it works: This is the standard "Reflexive Perception." It covers spotting ambushes and noticing details out of place. Actively, it represents a "security sweep."

* Option C: Examination

* The Vibe: Clinical, deliberate, and scientific.

* Why it works: It cleanly separates from Lore. Lore is knowing about the poison; Examination is finding the puncture wound. It covers forensics, searching rooms, and autopsy-style analysis.

* Option D: Discovery

- * The Vibe: Adventurous and rewarding.

- * Why it works: It reframes the "check" not as "looking" but as "finding." You roll Discovery to spot the secret door, find the clue, or notice the glint of a sniper's scope.

2. The Social Tree: The "Input/Output" Gap

The Need: Since Influence covers all Output (Protocol, Lying, Persuasion) and Streetwise covers the Environment, you are missing the Input (Reading people) or the Management (Systems).

- * Option A: Insight (The Strongest Contender)

- * The Concept: If Influence is your sword, Insight is your shield.

- * Why it works: Influence allows you to lie; Insight allows you to catch a lie. Influence lets you command; Insight lets you sense motive. It is the necessary counter-weight to a heavy Influence skill.

- * Option B: Stewardship

- * The Concept: The skill of Kings and Bureaucrats.

- * Why it works: Influence gets you the throne; Stewardship keeps it. This covers bureaucracy, logistics, managing organizations, and law (Lex). It fits the Sovereignty and Civilization themes of your gods (Aurelion/Agora).

- * Option C: Dominion

- * The Concept: Social pressure and presence.

- * Why it works: A static measurement of your terrifying or inspiring aura. While Influence is the act of convincing, Dominion is the state of being obeyed. Used for interrogation or holding a room's attention without speaking.

- * Option D: Gambit

- * The Concept: Risk, gaming, and reading the odds.

- * Why it works: Distinct from lying (Influence). This is the skill of gambling, game theory, and reading "tells" in a high-stakes environment (like the Chronosynclastic Institute's casinos).

3. The Metaphysical Tree: The "Application" Gap

The Need: You have Metaphysics (Theory/Knowledge) and Operate (Magitech/Devices). You need 2 more to hit your 4-skill target.

- * Skill 3: Discipline (The Shield)

- * The Concept: Mental fortitude and magical endurance.

- * Why it works: You have a "Condition Track" system. You need a skill to resist Strain, maintain focus on a spell while taking damage, or suppress a mutation. It is the "Constitution" of the magical soul.

- * Skill 4: Ritual (The Engine)

- * The Concept: Ceremonial application of power.

- * Why it works: Casting a fireball is a combat action; binding a Vestige, summoning an Eidolon, or purifying a Planar Bleed zone is a Ritual. This supports your Summoning and Pact-making systems mechanically.

Summary Recommendation

This set gives you a clean 4x4 grid with no overlap.

| Physical | Mental | Social | Metaphysical |

|---|---|---|---|

| Athletics (Body) | Lore (Knowledge) | Influence (Output/Active) | Metaphysics (Theory) |

| Skullduggery (Hands) | Medicine (Biology) | Streetwise (Context/Urban) | Operate (Devices) |
| Survival (Nature) | Artifice (Creation) | Performance (Expression) | Discipline
(Resistance/Focus) |
| Conveyance (Motion) | Discernment (Senses) | Insight (Input/Reading) | Ritual
(Binding/Ceremony) |

I like Discovery or Discernment as they both fit what I'm looking for. I'm leaning towards Discovery though rather than Discernment it just feels more at home in a world that is literally designed to be explored. I already have insight as a skill. Dominion is an ability. I'm not really seeing the practical side of stewardship.

Gambit has potential but I can't put my finger on why other than it's not the same take as everyone else. You're right it does touch on probability and works for not just one college but the whole setting. Gambit feels to gamey rather than expressing the underlying probabilities and understanding probability as a math or equation. The chronosynclastic aren't playing the system they are understanding the game and pulling on the strings of probability.

I said if we develop a system for concentration it needs to stay with the spell sentence system rather than being a skill. I didn't want defense mechanics mixed in with skills. Binding to a lacuna is a forbidden and taboo. Summoning an "Eidolon" is just shaping raw magic to form a construct which is handled elsewhere. "Purifying" a planar bleed zone is a function of metaphysical.

So try again with a different missing skill set.

This is coming together perfectly. We are locking in Conveyance (Physical) and Discovery (Mental).

This leaves us with 1 Social Slot (The "System/Math" Gap) and 2 Metaphysical Slots (The "Interaction/Senses" Gap) to fill.

Since Influence covers all active social output (lying, diplomacy, command) and Insight covers social defense, the missing Social skill must be the "Intellect of Society"—the skill for understanding systems, value, and probability, fitting your Chronosynclastic and Commerce themes.

For Metaphysical, since Metaphysics is your "Science/Theory/Purification" and Operate is your "Engineering/Devices," we need skills for the senses (seeing the invisible) and the script (runes/wards) or flow (raw energy).

Here are 4 targeted options for each remaining gap.

The Social Gap: The "System & Probability" Skill

The skill of Game Theory, Economics, and Strategy. Not "playing" the person (Influence), but understanding the board they are standing on.

* Option A: Strategy

* The Vibe: Commanding, forward-thinking, and mathematical.

* Why it works: It fits Stormpeak (War), Chronosynclastic (Game Theory/Probability), and Sovereign Exchange (Market Trends). It covers planning, logistics, calculating odds, and outmaneuvering an opponent before you even speak.

* Option B: Valuation

* The Vibe: Mercenary, precise, and high-stakes.

* Why it works: This is the skill of Worth and Risk. You use it to appraise an item, assess the danger of a mission, or calculate the leverage you have over a rival. It turns social interactions into an equation of cost vs. benefit.

* Option C: Logistics

* The Vibe: Practical, industrial, and essential.

* Why it works: If Influence is the "General," Logistics is the "Quartermaster." It covers moving resources, navigating bureaucracy, and understanding supply chains. It makes you a master of how things happen in a complex civilization (Agora).

* Option D: Dynamics

* The Vibe: Fluid, observant, and structural.

* Why it works: Represents understanding the "flow" of a city, a court, or a casino. It's reading the power structures, spotting the outliers in the data, and understanding the invisible pressures moving the crowd.

The Metaphysical Gaps: The "Senses & Script" Skills

We need 2 skills here to round out the tree. These options are paired concepts.

* Option Set A: Resonance & Symbolology

* Resonance (Sensory): The ability to perceive magical frequencies, auras, and Planar Bleed. While "Metaphysics" tells you what a ghost is, Resonance lets you see it or track its emotional echo.

* Symbolology (Written/Code): The skill of Runes, Glyphs, and Wards. distinct from "Theory." This is the coding language of magic—writing a warding circle, deciphering an ancient text, or disabling a magical trap (Abjuration/Deepguard).

* Option Set B: Attunement & Channeling

* Attunement (Connection): The skill of safely bonding with items, places, or Vestiges. It covers the "Interface" with the supernatural without casting spells.

* Channeling (Flow): The skill of handling raw magical energy. Used to charge batteries, stabilize a volatile reaction, or act as a conduit for a ritual.

* Option Set C: Witness & Invocation

* Witness (Observation): A passive, "Witch-Sight" skill. Seeing the strings of fate or the seams of reality (Chiaroscuro).

* Invocation (Activation): The skill of using pre-made magical items that aren't machines—scrolls, wands, staves, and fetishes. "Operate" handles the tech; Invocation handles the artifacts.

* Option Set D: Harmonics & Weaving

* Harmonics (Frequency): Fitting the Chorus of the Heart and Cephalarchs. Magic as music/vibration. Tuning forks, singing bowls, and counter-song.

* Weaving (Shaping): The manipulation of "soft" magic—illusions, dreams, and shadows.

My Recommendation

To fit the "Science vs. Art" and "Academy vs. Wild" themes of your setting:

* Social: Strategy (It anchors the rigorous, academic feel of your Colleges while covering the "Probability/Math" aspect of the Chronosynclastic Institute).

* Metaphysical 1: Resonance (You need a "Perception" skill for magic to track Bleed and see invisible threats).

* Metaphysical 2: Symbology (With Deepguard using wards and Vestus using books/secrets, having a dedicated skill for "Written Magic/Runes" is essential).

Your Final Grid would look like this:

| Physical | Mental | Social | Metaphysical |

|---|---|---|---|

| Athletics | Lore | Influence | Metaphysics (Theory) |

| Skullduggery | Medicine | Streetwise | Operate (Devices) |

| Survival | Artifice | Performance | Resonance (Senses) |

| Conveyance | Discovery | Strategy | Symbology (Runes) |

I like Valuation or Dynamics. Probably valuation, because you evaluate situations and probabilities in the same way without being too militaristic and specifically applying the concept to the art of war.

I'm seeing that you're consistently pushing for magical awareness and magical forces of the environment manipulation which both makes sense for the setting. A lot of your suggestions are sound or vibration based and it's annoying. I don't want to "attune" to magic or use "harmonics". "Resonance" is an empty word.

Give me 4 options for the awareness or perception of magic and 4 options for the manipulation of magic.

You've made a great choice with Valuation. It perfectly fits the "Mercantile/Systemic" gap without overlapping with the militaristic tone of Strategy or the interpersonal tone of Influence.

We are locking in:

* Physical: Athletics, Skullduggery, Survival, Conveyance.

* Mental: Lore, Medicine, Artifice, Discovery.

* Social: Influence, Streetwise, Performance, Valuation.

Now, let's solve the Metaphysical tree. You have Metaphysics (Knowledge/Spellcraft) and Operate (Devices). We need to fill the Sensory gap (without sound/vibrations) and the Manipulation gap (handling the environment/forces without "concentration" mechanics).

Here are 4 options for Magical Awareness and 4 options for Magical Manipulation.

Gap 1: Magical Awareness (The Senses)

Constraints: Visual, instinctual, or mental. No "Resonance," "Harmonics," or sound themes.

* Lucidity

* The Concept: The ability to see reality as it is, piercing through the "Smoothing Effect."

* Why it works: It fits the Chiaroscuro theme of "seeing the seams." It's not just detecting magic; it's recognizing what is fake, spotting illusions, and seeing the cracks in the world (Planar Bleed) before they rupture. It implies a clarity of mind that "superimposes" the magical truth over the physical world.

- * Spectra

- * The Concept: Scientific and visual. Seeing magic as wavelengths of light and color.

- * Why it works: Fits the Kanon/Academic view of magic as a physics system. You don't "feel" an aura; you see a "Necrotic Redshift" or a "Conjuration Ultraviolet." It makes the skill feel analytical and precise—used for tracking magical signatures like thermal optics.

- * Instinct

- * The Concept: Primal, gut-level warning system.

- * Why it works: Fits the Verdena/Wildpath themes. Magic is part of the ecosystem. This isn't about analyzing the spell; it's the hair standing up on your neck before a portal opens. It covers "danger sense" and reacting to magical predators without needing to study them first.

- * Vision

- * The Concept: The classic "Second Sight" or "The Third Eye."

- * Why it works: Simple, functional, and mystical. It implies a toggled state of being where you look into the Ethereal/Palimpsest. It covers seeing ghosts, spirits, and invisible constructs. It is the direct magical counterpart to physical observation.

Gap 2: Magical Manipulation (The Environment)

Constraints: Interactive and environmental. No "Attuning" (passive) or "Concentration" (defense). This is the skill of handling the dangerous "stuff" of magic.

- * Symbolology

- * The Concept: The "Code" of magic. Runes, Glyphs, and Wards.

- * Why it works: Matches Deepguard's focus on security and wards. This is the skill of writing or breaking the script. You use it to disable a magical trap (by scratching out a rune), seal a room, or draw a containment circle. It turns magic into an engineering/language problem.

- * Channeling

- * The Concept: Becoming a conduit for flow.

- * Why it works: Matches Stormpeak's energy focus. This is used when you need to bridge a circuit, safely ground a volatile artifact, or siphon energy from a battery to a door. It represents the physical fortitude required to let raw magic flow through you or your tools without burning out.

- * Weaving

- * The Concept: Tactile manipulation of the "Fabric."

- * Why it works: Fits the Fates/Illusion themes. Reality is a tapestry; this skill lets you pull on the threads. You use it to stabilize a Planar Tear (sewing it shut), unravel a persistent spell effect, or reshape a cloud of "Fog" into a wall. It treats magic as a malleable material.

- * Flux

- * The Concept: Managing chaos and instability.

- * Why it works: Fits the Alchemical/Mutation themes. Magic in your world is radioactive and unstable (Strain). Flux is the skill of handling that instability—stabilizing a mutation, safely transporting volatile "Prima Aether," or navigating a chaotic storm in the Borderlands without being corrupted.

My Recommendation for the "Academy" Feel:

- * Awareness: Lucidity (It reinforces the "World is a Simulation/Construct" vibe and the danger of the "Smoothing Effect").

* Manipulation: Symbology (It gives non-casters a way to interact with magic—hacking runes—and fits the ancient/ruined world aesthetic).

The Final Metaphysical Tree would be:

- * Metaphysics (Knowledge/Theory)
- * Operate (Magitech/Devices)
- * Lucidity (Visual Awareness/Seams)
- * Symbology (Runes/Wards/Scripting)

I like instinct. Your manipulation options are lack luster give me 4 others

We are locking in Instinct for the Sensory gap. It fits the "Verdena/Wildpath" vibe perfectly—magic isn't a song to be heard, it's a predator in the tall grass that you feel.

So your grid is nearly complete:

- * Physical: Athletics, Skullduggery, Survival, Conveyance.
- * Mental: Lore, Medicine, Artifice, Discovery.
- * Social: Influence, Streetwise, Performance, Valuation.
- * Metaphysical: Metaphysics (Theory), Operate (Devices), Instinct (Sensory), [MANIPULATION GAP].

Here are 4 options for the Magical Manipulation skill. These are active, tactile, and gritty. No vibrations, no "tuning," no passive attunement. This is blue-collar work for the soul.

1. Inscription

- * The Concept: The skill of the Code.
- * The Action: Magic in your world often requires a physical medium to be safe. Inscription is the act of carving runes, drawing containment circles, tattooing wards, or scratching "glitch-text" into a wall to lock a door.
- * Why it works: It distinguishes the Writer from the Caster. You use this to disable a magical trap (by scratching out the rune), seal a room against spirits, or create a permanent anchor for a ritual. It fits Deepguard and the "Ancient Ruins" aesthetic perfectly.

2. Siphoning

- * The Concept: The skill of the Leech.
- * The Action: Magic is a fuel source. Siphoning is the ability to safely draw raw Aether out of something without it exploding.
- * Why it works: It fits the Industrial/Thalassus themes. You use this to drain the energy from a capturing crystal, harvest "Prima Aether" from a dead beast, vent a dangerous build-up of radiation, or suck the mana out of a rival's shield. It treats magic as a hazardous liquid that can be moved.

3. Imposition

- * The Concept: The skill of the Tyrant.
- * The Action: Magic is chaotic; this skill is the application of pure Willpower to force it to behave. It is not "shaping" carefully; it is crushing the reality into the shape you want.
- * Why it works: It fits Aurelion/Sovereignty. You use this to hold a portal open by mental force, suppress a wild mutation in your own body, or win a "Clash of Wills" against a possessed object. It is the strength check of the mind.

4. Anchoring

- * The Concept: The skill of the Warden.
 - * The Action: Reality is trying to tear itself apart (Planar Bleed); Anchoring is the skill of nailing it back down.
 - * Why it works: It fits Aion/Stability. You use this to stabilize a flickering illusion, lock a teleportation destination so you don't drift, or "ground" a volatile artifact so it doesn't detonate. It is the skill of keeping things real.
- Recommendation
- * If you want the setting to feel Ancient/Runed: Pick Inscription.
 - * If you want the setting to feel Industrial/Resource-Heavy: Pick Siphoning.
 - * If you want the setting to feel Unstable/Broken: Pick Anchoring.

Here are 4 dynamic, high-utility options for the final Metaphysical Manipulation slot. Since you have Metaphysics (Theory), Operate (Devices), and Instinct (Sensory), this last skill needs to be the "Hands-on" interaction with raw magic.

1. Invocation

- * The Concept: The skill of Using.
- * The Action: This is your "Use Magic Device" equivalent. It covers safely activating scrolls, wands, staves, and artifacts that you didn't create. It represents the ability to force a magical tool to obey you, even if you lack the specific spellcasting talent.
- * Why it fits: Essential for non-mages who want to utilize loot. It fits the Vestus/Archivist theme of using lost knowledge and the Generalist College theme of broad competency.

2. Manifestation

- * The Concept: The skill of Shaping.
- * The Action: Raw Aether is formless; this skill gives it shape. Use it to mold a "fog" spell into a wall, use telekinesis to bridge a gap, or stabilize a crumbling summoned construct. It is the physical exertion of will upon energy.
- * Why it fits: Matches the Chiaroscuro (Illusion) and Stormpeak (Force) themes. It turns magic into a tactile tool that can be pushed, pulled, and sculpted.

3. Interdiction

- * The Concept: The skill of Denial.
- * The Action: Active counter-measures. Use this to disrupt a ritual, parry an incoming spell with raw Aether, disperse a magical cloud, or "ground" a lightning trap before it triggers. It is the martial art of anti-magic.
- * Why it fits: Perfect for the Deepguard (Abjuration) and Militant themes. It gives non-casters a way to fight back against mages by disrupting their "flow."

4. Binding

- * The Concept: The skill of Knots.
- * The Action: Forging and maintaining the connection between entities. Use this to secure a Contract with a summoned creature, tether a drifting portal so it stays open, or lock a Vestige into a vessel.
- * Why it fits: Directly supports your Companion/Pet and Summoning systems. It differentiates the "Caller" (who summons) from the "Binder" (who keeps it there).

My Recommendation: Invocation or Binding

- * If you want the game to be about Artifacts and Lost Tech, take Invocation.

* If you want the game to be about Creatures and Pacts, take Binding.

I think this last selection is closer to what I'm wanting but they all had strange connotations. Let's get 4 more that echo invocation, manifestation, and binding.

You want words that capture the active power of Invocation (calling/triggering), Manifestation (making real), and Binding (control/connection) without the baggage of "leeching" (Siphoning) or "writing" (Inscription).

Here are 4 options that feel active, capable, and fit the "Magi-Tech Academy" tone.

1. Praxis

* The Echo: Echoes Manifestation and Application.

* The Concept: In an academic setting, Metaphysics is the "Theory," and Praxis is the "Lab Work."

* Why it fits: It covers the practical, messy reality of handling magic. It's the skill of activating the wand, stabilizing the ritual, or forcing the spell to work when the formula fails. It implies that magic is something you do, not just something you know.

2. Induction

* The Echo: Echoes Invocation and Channeling.

* The Concept: Borrowed from physics (electromagnetic induction). It is the act of forcing a current to flow or a reaction to start.

* Why it fits: It fits the "Energy/Industrial" feel of Stormpeak and the Colleges. You use Induction to trigger a dormant artifact, jump-start a golem, or force a spirit to manifest by "inducing" a magical charge in the air. It feels powerful and scientific.

3. Tether

* The Echo: Echoes Binding and Anchoring.

* The Concept: A tactile, spatial term. It implies creating a line between two things that cannot be broken.

* Why it fits: It covers the "Summoner/Warden" fantasy. You use Tether to hold a demon in a circle, lock a portal open so your team can escape, or keep your own soul attached to your body while projecting. It is the skill of maintaining connection under stress.

4. Thaumaturgy

* The Echo: Echoes Invocation and Ritual.

* The Concept: The classical term for "Wonder Working" (distinct from Sorcery or Wizardry). It usually implies the use of tools, symbols, and rites to produce effects.

* Why it fits: It is the perfect catch-all for "Non-Caster Magic." If you aren't a wizard, you use Thaumaturgy to cheat. You use it to hack a ward, falsify a magical signature, or wring one last charge out of a broken staff. It feels ancient and capable.

Final Grid Recommendation

If you go with Praxis or Thaumaturgy, you get a skill that sounds like a University course but plays like an adventurer's tool.

| Physical | Mental | Social | Metaphysical |

|---|---|---|---|

| Athletics | Lore | Influence | Metaphysics (Theory) |

| Skullduggery | Medicine | Streetwise | Operate (Technology) |

| Survival | Artifice | Performance | Instinct (Senses) |
| Conveyance | Discovery | Valuation | Praxis (Application) |

We are locking in Praxis. It is the perfect capstone for your "Academy-First" setting. It implies that magic is not just an art or a prayer—it is a discipline with standard operating procedures, experimental methods, and tangible results.

Here is your complete, finalized 16-Skill Grid for the Aetherium Codex.

The Aetherium Codex Skill System

| Physical (Body & Motion) | Mental (Logic & Analysis) | Social (Interaction & System) |

Metaphysical (The Soul & Magic) |

---|---|---|---

| Athletics | Lore | Influence | Metaphysics |

| Skullduggery | Medicine | Streetwise | Operate |

| Survival | Artifice | Performance | Instinct |

| Conveyance | Discovery | Valuation | Praxis |

Skill Definitions Reference

Physical Tree

* Athletics: Running, climbing, swimming, and raw physical exertion. Used for chases, feats of strength, and endurance.

* Skullduggery: Fine manipulation, stealth, and theft. Used for picking locks, sleight of hand, and moving unseen.

* Survival: Navigation, tracking, and enduring the elements. Used for finding food, shelter, and pathfinding in the wild.

* Conveyance: The mastery of vehicles and mounts. Used for piloting void-skiffs, riding beasts, and handling chariots or steam-walkers.

Mental Tree

* Lore: Academic knowledge, history, and language. Used to recall facts, translate text, and identify cultures.

* Medicine: Anatomy, healing, and biology. Used to stabilize the dying, treat disease, and perform autopsy/forensics.

* Artifice: Engineering, crafting, and repair. Used to build items, fix broken tech, and understand mechanical systems.

* Discovery: Active search and deduction. Used to find hidden doors, spot clues at a crime scene, and notice tactical details.

Social Tree

* Influence: Active persuasion, command, and deception. Used to lie, intimidate, inspire, or negotiate a treaty.

* Streetwise: Urban survival and criminal contact. Used to gather rumors, find a fence, or navigate the underworld.

* Performance: Art, expression, and emotion. Used to act a part, play an instrument, or distract a crowd.

* Valuation: The assessment of worth, risk, and probability. Used to appraise goods, calculate odds, and negotiate prices or contracts.

Metaphysical Tree

- * Metaphysics: Theoretical knowledge of magic. Used to identify spells, understand planar physics, and recall arcane lore.
- * Operate: The use of magi-tech devices. Used to drive a golem, program a crystal, or hack a magical security console.
- * Instinct: Primal magical awareness. Used to "feel" a portal opening, sense a predator's aura, or react to magical danger.
- * Praxis: The practical application of raw magic. Used to activate artifacts, stabilize rituals, or force a magical effect without a spell slot.

Here are the codified summaries for the 16 Core Skills of the Aetherium Codex, tailored to the setting's specific magi-tech and planar themes.

The Physical Tree (Body & Motion)

Primary Attributes: Might, Finesse, Vigor

- * Athletics
 - * The Vibe: The raw engine of the body.
 - * Core Function: Covers all forms of gross physical exertion: climbing, swimming, jumping, sprinting, and feats of strength.
 - * Codex Context: Essential for navigating the verticality of the Nexus Spire or enduring the physical toll of traversing the Borderlands.
- * Skullduggery
 - * The Vibe: The unseen hand.
 - * Core Function: Covers fine motor manipulation and stealth. Includes picking locks, disabling mechanical traps, sleight of hand, and moving silently.
 - * Codex Context: The favored tool of Varis's faithful and corporate spies within the Sovereign Exchange. If Artifice builds the lock, Skullduggery bypasses it.
- * Survival
 - * The Vibe: Enduring the wild.
 - * Core Function: Covers tracking, foraging, navigating wilderness, and identifying natural hazards.
 - * Codex Context: Critical for dealing with Planar Bleed zones where the laws of physics shift. Used by the Wildpath Wardens to hunt mutated fauna and navigate the Verdant Font.
- * Conveyance
 - * The Vibe: Mastery of motion.
 - * Core Function: The operation of any external mode of transport. Covers piloting void-skiffs, driving steam-walkers, riding biological mounts, and handling chariot teams.
 - * Codex Context: A vital skill in a world of floating islands. Whether you are a Deepguard tunneling-machine operator or a knight riding a Chimera, this is your control skill.

The Mental Tree (Logic & Analysis)

Primary Attributes: Intellect, Wits

- * Lore
 - * The Vibe: The library of the mind.
 - * Core Function: Passive knowledge. Covers history, religion (The Pantheon), geography, and culture.

- * Codex Context: The domain of Vestus (The Archivist). Used to recall the history of the Sundered Society or translate dead languages found in the Silent Athenaeum.

- * Medicine

- * The Vibe: The preservation of flesh.

- * Core Function: Anatomy, surgery, first aid, and the treatment of disease and poison.

- * Codex Context: Distinct from magical healing. In a world of Mutations and Alchemical Strain, Medicine is the science of keeping the body stable when magic tries to warp it.

- * Artifice

- * The Vibe: The builder's code.

- * Core Function: Crafting, repairing, and engineering. Covers blacksmithing, clockwork, structural engineering, and sabotage.

- * Codex Context: The holy work of Daedalon. Used to repair airships, construct defenses, or analyze the structural weakness of a ruin.

- * Discovery

- * The Vibe: The detective's eye.

- * Core Function: Active search and deduction. Covers searching a room for contraband, forensics, finding secret doors, and noticing tactical details in combat.

- * Codex Context: The primary skill of the Inquisitor. Unlike Lore (knowing a fact), Discovery is finding the clue that reveals the fact. It is piercing the "Smoothing Effect" to find the truth hidden underneath.

The Social Tree (Interaction & Systems)

Primary Attributes: Presence, Guile, Composure

- * Influence

- * The Vibe: The force of personality.

- * Core Function: Active social manipulation. Covers persuasion, deception, intimidation, leadership, and negotiation.

- * Codex Context: The weapon of Aurelion (Sovereignty). Whether you are commanding a legion or lying to a guard, you are imposing your will upon another.

- * Streetwise

- * The Vibe: The pulse of the city.

- * Core Function: Urban survival and networking. Covers gathering rumors, finding black markets, navigating bureaucracy, and identifying criminal hierarchies.

- * Codex Context: Essential in the massive metropolis of the Unity Academy or the docks of the Exchange. It is knowing who to talk to, not just how to talk.

- * Performance

- * The Vibe: The art of expression.

- * Core Function: Captivating an audience. Covers music, oratory, acting, and disguise kits.

- * Codex Context: The domain of the Chiaroscuro Institute. Used to distract guards, incite a crowd, or maintain a "Persona" that protects your identity from magical scrying.

- * Valuation

- * The Vibe: The calculus of worth.

- * Core Function: Assessing risk, value, and probability. Covers appraising items, gambling/gaming, negotiating prices, and spotting leverage in a deal.

* Codex Context: The hallmark of the Chronosynclastic Institute and the Sovereign Exchange. It turns social encounters into math: identifying the odds, the cost, and the profit margin of any action.

The Metaphysical Tree (The Soul & Magic)

Primary Attributes: Acuity, Dominion, Anima

* Metaphysics

* The Vibe: The theory of the arcane.

* Core Function: Academic knowledge of magic. Covers identifying spells, understanding planar physics, and recognizing magical phenomena.

* Codex Context: The "Science" of Kanon. Used to analyze a Planar Bleed zone to understand why it is happening or to design a new spell formula.

* Operate

* The Vibe: The interface of power.

* Core Function: Using magical technology. Covers activating consoles, piloting golems, tuning crystals, and "hacking" magical devices.

* Codex Context: In the Codex, magic is industrial. Operate is the skill of the technician running the Mana-Turbines at Stormpeak or the Security Wards at Deepguard.

* Instinct

* The Vibe: The sixth sense.

* Core Function: Sensory magical awareness. Covers "feeling" a portal open, sensing the aura of a predator, or detecting invisible presence through hair-raising intuition.

* Codex Context: The "Wild" magic of Verdena and Anima. It is not about analyzing the spell (Metaphysics); it is about knowing something is wrong before it kills you.

* Praxis

* The Vibe: The application of will.

* Core Function: Hands-on magical interaction. Covers activating magic items (UMD), binding spirits, stabilizing volatile rituals, and scribing/breaking wards.

* Codex Context: The "Blue-Collar" magic skill. Used by non-wizards to force a wand to trigger, or by Deepguard specialists to physically scratch a containment rune into a doorframe to seal a breach.

What abilities do these skills go to? Keep them to their appropriate ability sections. Wits isn't in the physical section.

might, finesse, vigor, for physical

Intellect, wits, acuity for mental

Presence, Composure, and guile for social

And

Integrity, Dominion, and anima for metaphysical

Here is the distribution of your 16 Skills into their corresponding Attribute assignments.

Physical Skills

(Attributes: Might, Finesse, Vigor)

- * Athletics (Might): Relies on explosive power and raw strength for climbing, jumping, and swimming.
- * Skullduggery (Finesse): Relies on fine motor manipulation and dexterity for lockpicking and sleight of hand.
- * Conveyance (Finesse): Relies on reflexes and coordination for steering, piloting, and riding.
- * Survival (Vigor): Relies on physical endurance and resilience to withstand the elements and long treks.

Mental Skills

(Attributes: Intellect, Wits, Acuity)

- * Lore (Intellect): Relies on memory, education, and raw processing power.
- * Medicine (Intellect): Relies on anatomical knowledge and academic understanding of biology.
- * Discovery (Wits): Relies on quick deduction, investigative intuition, and thinking on your feet.
- * Artifice (Acuity): Relies on precision, an eye for detail, and the sharp focus required for engineering and repair.

Social Skills

(Attributes: Presence, Composure, Guile)

- * Influence (Presence): Relies on the active projection of personality to command or persuade.
- * Performance (Presence): Relies on charisma and the ability to capture and hold an audience's attention.
- * Streetwise (Guile): Relies on subtlety, manipulation, and navigating social undercurrents deceitfully.
- * Valuation (Composure): Relies on maintaining a poker face, hiding your own "tell," and coolly assessing risk under pressure.

Metaphysical Skills

(Attributes: Integrity, Dominion, Anima)

- * Metaphysics (Integrity): Relies on understanding the structural laws and stability of reality (The Pattern).
- * Operate (Dominion): Relies on enforcing your will upon a machine spirit or device to make it obey.
- * Praxis (Dominion): Relies on the force of will required to bind spirits, shape spells, or stabilize rituals.
- * Instinct (Anima): Relies on your connection to the raw soul-stuff of the universe to sense magical flows.